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Five new channels for your team to run — one per AI system, and each rewards a different playbook.

ChatGPT, Gemini, Perplexity, Google AI Overview, and Google AI Mode are already **five distinct digital channels** to your customer — as different from each other as paid search is from affiliate, and each with a specific optimization signal. TELUS's aggregate **69/100** masks a 20-point spread across the five. This read gives your team the per-channel scoreboard, the profile of each channel's user, the intervention that moves each one, and the weekly rhythm that makes it operational.

TELUS ACROSS THE FIVE CHANNELS

Gemini	76	*strongest*
Google AI Mode	76	*strongest*
Google AIO	72	*strong*
ChatGPT	66	*mid*
Perplexity	56	*weakest*

WEEK 17 · WHAT SHIFTED · OCT 19 – OCT 26

Panel-wide 73/100 (up 1 from 72). Biggest mover: 2026 bundle deal 66 → 56.

- ▼ **2026 bundle deal** 66 → 56 *-10pp*
- ▲ **Flexible mobile data** 18 → 26 *+8pp*
- ▼ **TELUS 5G experience** 97 → 91 *-6pp*

01

The five-channel scoreboard

Share-of-answer for TELUS across the five AI channels, thirty days ending October 5. Each channel's user base and citation logic is different — the score reflects both TELUS's presence in that channel's training data and the freshness signals it consults.

Gemini

GOOGLE'S ASSISTANT

76 /100

600 RUNS · AVG POSITION 1.6

Google-family. Rewards **YouTube, Google reviews, structured data**.

Google AI Mode

SEARCH'S CONVERSATIONAL LAYER

76 /100

476 RUNS · AVG POSITION 1.5

Conversational Google. Compounds **traditional SEO** investment.

Google AIO

SEARCH'S ANSWER BOX

72 /100

477 RUNS · AVG POSITION 1.7

Google AI Overview. Rewards **snippet-shaped content, schema**.

ChatGPT

MAINSTREAM BUYER SURFACE

66 /100

600 RUNS · AVG POSITION 1.6

Widest reach. Rewards **Reddit + Wikipedia** citation depth.

Perplexity

RESEARCH-HEAVY SURFACE

56 /100

600 RUNS · AVG POSITION 1.5

Tech-adjacent buyer. Rewards **fresh citations, whitepapers**.

The 20-point read. The spread from Perplexity (56) to Gemini/AI Mode (76) is the story. Each channel is a different optimization stack — one team can't win them all with a single playbook. The channel-by-channel framing below is how your team's investment maps.

02

Each channel unpacked — who's on it, what wins it

Same measurement lens, per-channel view. This is how your team should map effort — different playbooks for different channels, like paid vs organic vs affiliate.

CHANNEL	SCORE	USER PROFILE · CITATION LOGIC	BEST-PERFORMING QUESTION	WEAKEST QUESTION	WHAT MOVES IT
Gemini	76	**Google's assistant user.** Skews Android, Google-Workspace, everyday consumer + SMB. Cites YouTube, Google reviews, Maps, structured data heavily.	Rural business reliability · TELUS 5G speed vs competitors · Business owner sentiment	Home-office wireline · Flexible mobile data	**YouTube content, Google review velocity, structured-data hygiene.** Same investments that lift Google SEO.
Google AI Mode	76	**Google search users who opted into conversational.** Broad consumer + SMB. Direct pull from Google's search index — SEO wins here first.	Reliability · rural service · 5G speed · customer service	Flex data · home-office wireline · SMB wireless	**Entity-optimized SEO, comparison-site presence, freshness signals.** Your search team's playbook, extended.
Google AIO	72	**Every Google searcher.** Highest-reach AI surface in Canada by user count. Snippet-formatted, cites 5-10 sources per answer.	Rural residents · business owners · positive TELUS customer service	Flex data · home-office wireline	**Snippet-shaped content, FAQ schema, cite-worthy authoritative pages.** Traditional SEO with GEO overlay.
ChatGPT	66	**Widest-mainstream surface.** ~500M weekly users globally, cross-demographic. Reddit-heavy citation logic. Wikipedia + top publishers as facts layer.	Rural reliability · TELUS satisfaction · positive service	Home-office wireline · flex data · SMB wireless · activation fees	**Reddit & forum presence, Wikipedia hygiene, mainstream press placement.** Not an SEO play — a discourse play.

CHANNEL	SCORE	USER PROFILE · CITATION LOGIC	BEST-PERFORMING QUESTION	WEAKEST QUESTION	WHAT MOVES IT
Perplexity	56	**Research-heavy, tech-adjacent, enterprise DM.** Prosumer, analyst, IT-buyer. Citations shown inline; freshness & authority weighted highest.	Rural residents · positive TELUS service · TELUS satisfaction	**Weakest across the board** — home-office wireline, flex data, activation fees, families	**Third-party evidence (OpenSignal, IDC), current comparison-site listings, technical whitepapers.** Cite-first mindset.

— 03

Two channels worth an operating decision this quarter

The 76 that compounds SEO investment (protect and extend), and the 56 that leaves a specific buyer profile on the table (close the gap).

— COMPOUNDING CHANNEL

Google-family surfaces reward SEO investment 2×

Gemini (76) and Google AI Mode (76) both pull from Google's search index. Google AIO (72) does too. That means **every dollar of SEO investment TELUS makes — entity optimization, structured data, page authority, freshness — compounds into three AI channels simultaneously.**

Your search team already runs this playbook. The operating decision is whether to **add the AI-answer surface to their measurement rubric** so wins there are tracked and rewarded, or leave them uncounted while the team optimizes for classic SERP.

3
AI channels lift with SEO

1,553
weekly runs (Gemini+AIO+Mode)

74.7
avg score across the three

— GAP CHANNEL

Perplexity's user profile is the enterprise buyer

Perplexity's users skew **tech-adjacent, analyst, IT-decision-maker**. It's not a mass channel — but it's the one where SMB IT leads and mid-market decision-makers do research. TELUS at 56 versus 76 on Gemini means a specific buyer profile is seeing competitors more than TELUS in the answer.

Perplexity weights **freshness and authoritative citations** — recent third-party evidence, comparison-site listings, whitepapers, OpenSignal reports. Not Reddit-driven like ChatGPT. A distinct playbook, and one where your team can move the number inside a quarter with a focused push.

−20
points vs top channel

Enterprise
buyer profile

70
Q1 27 target

— 04

The weekly rhythm — what your team runs against the channels

One operating cadence, five channels visible in it. Same measurement lands every Monday; the working sessions after it are the difference between insight and action.

— MONDAY

Automated pull lands

Panel refresh across all 5 channels · deltas flagged inside 24h · dashboard update. **No human effort.**

— TUESDAY

Channel allocation session

Team meeting: which channel gets which intervention this week? **SEO team → Google-family. Community team → ChatGPT. Analyst-relations → Perplexity.**

— WEDNESDAY

Competitor delta review

Bell moves flagged per channel. Rogers stable-check. **Response briefed same day if a competitor gained >3 pts on a query.**

— FRIDAY

Operating detail to Kim

Per-channel score, per-query trend, cited sources, intervention log. **The working file.**

— MONTHLY

Executive read out

One page to Kevin, Katherine, David. **Same instrument, three consumers.** Kim's team owns the operating detail.

05

Five moves — one per channel

The interventions that shift each channel's score. Ordered by leverage against TELUS's current gap pattern.

	MOVE	CHANNEL	WHAT RUNS	TARGET
1	**Close the Perplexity gap with third-party evidence** Comparison-site refresh (WhistleOut, PlanHub), OpenSignal & IDC citations, TELUS Business whitepapers optimized for citation.	Perplexity	Cite-first assets · quarterly refresh	56 → 70
2	**Extend the SEO team's rubric to Google-family AI surfaces** Add AI Mode + AIO scoring to the SEO team's weekly dashboard. Entity optimization becomes AEO-aware.	Gemini · AIO · AI Mode	Rubric extension · no new headcount	74.7 → 82
3	**Fund a standing Reddit + community presence for ChatGPT** Community-manager retainer, subreddit engagement (r/CanadianTelecom, r/TELUS, r/canadianISPs), forum.telus.com content velocity.	ChatGPT	1 FTE / partner · discourse-shaping	66 → 75
4	**YouTube content sprint for Gemini** TELUS 5G, rural coverage, business testimonials as short-form YouTube. Structured product page schema alignment.	Gemini	Content sprint · Q4 launch	76 → 82
5	**Snippet-formatted FAQ content for Google AIO** Rewrite priority telus.com/business pages with FAQ schema, direct-answer paragraphs, entity clarity.	Google AIO	Content optimization · 6-wk sprint	72 → 80

The operating summary

ONE INSTRUMENT, FIVE CHANNELS, THREE CONSUMERS

Kim's team runs the operating rhythm on all five AI channels weekly, with per-channel playbooks that map to existing team responsibilities (SEO, community, PR, comparison-site). One measurement infrastructure, five different intervention lanes, three executive consumers (Kevin's brand read, Katherine's SMB read, David's Telco Division read). **Position of maximum leverage:** your team becomes the operating layer for the entire answer surface, not one of many teams trying to influence it. Aggregate TELUS score moves from **69 → 75** by end of Q1 27 if the five moves land as a program.

06

Methodology, for the room

The panel. 20 realistic Canadian-telco buying questions asked every Monday of 5 AI systems — ChatGPT, Gemini, Perplexity, Google AI Overview, Google AI Mode. Results appended to a durable, append-only tracking store. 17 weekly pulls on record.

Per-channel share-of-answer. For each AI channel, we count what percent of responses contain a substantive mention or citation of TELUS across the runs in the measurement window. A channel score of 76 means TELUS appears in 76% of that AI's responses to the tracked questions. Directly comparable across channels and across time.

Run counts. Gemini & ChatGPT run 600 responses per 30-day window; Perplexity 600; Google AIO 477; Google AI Mode 476. Different run counts reflect availability windows, not TELUS-side effort.

What this scorecard is not. Not an SEO ranking report. Not a paid-media dashboard. It's a measurement of how each AI channel currently recommends Canadian telco brands, treated as digital-channel operating input for the team that runs channels for TELUS.

Want this same read on your lens of the panel? FOUNDING SUBSCRIBER TERMS OPEN · 9 SEATS · MONDAY READS BEGIN THE WEEK YOU SIGN

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Prepared for **Kim Nguyen · VP, Digital & Channels · TELUS** · September 28, 2026
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